

Michael B. Wong

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Management and Strategy, jointly appointed in Economics 2022-
HKU Business School, University of Hong Kong

Assistant Professor (by-courtesy) 2026-
HKU School of Governance and Policy, University of Hong Kong

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

Research Affiliate, IZA Network at LISER 2026-

Research Affiliate, Rockwool Foundation Berlin 2025-

Faculty Affiliate, HKU Stone Centre on Socio-Economic Inequality in Asia 2026-

Faculty Research Fellow, HKU Center for AI, Management, and Organizations 2026-

Affiliated Researcher, HKU Jockey Club ESG Research Institute 2024-

Fellow, HKU Centre on Contemporary China and the World 2023-

Member, HKU Real Estate Lab 2023-

COMMUNITY AFFILIATIONS

Founding Director and Chairperson, Hong Kong Future Economy Institute 2025-

Member, Hong Kong Housing Authority, Subsidised Housing Committee 2026-

External Consultant, Hong Kong Jockey Club 2023-

EDUCATION

PhD, Economics, *MIT*, 2022.

AB, Physics, *Harvard*, 2012. Minor in Computer Science. *Magna cum laude with highest distinction.*

PUBLICATIONS

- (1) “Ideological Bias and Trust in Information Sources” (joint with Matthew Gentzkow and Allen T. Zhang) *American Economic Journal: Microeconomics*.
- (2) “Domestic Outsourcing and Employment Security” (with Naijia Guo and Duoxi Li) *Accepted, Journal of Development Economics*
- (3) “Subsidize Rent or Subsidize Ownership? Evidence from a Hong Kong Experiment” *Conditionally accepted, Regional Science and Urban Economics*

WORKING PAPERS

- (4) “Managerial Coordination in Relational Contracting Markets” (with Duoxi Li) *Revise and Resubmit, Economic Journal*
- (5) “The Promise and Perils of Platform Money: Evidence from a Barter Community” *Revise and Resubmit, Economic Journal*
- (6) “Outsourcing, Labor Market Frictions, and Employment” (with Mayara Felix)
- (7) “Platform Currency Adoption and Redemption Design” (with Baiyun Jing, Yang You, and Yulin Zhong)
- (8) The Skill Content of AI: First-personal Experience and Returns to Human Capital

WORK-IN-PROGRESS

- (9) “Housing Market Responses to Non-market Allocation: An Assignment Approach” (with Jimmy Ho, Yulin Hong, and Zhongji Wei)
- (10) “Moral Hazard and the Cost of In-kind Transfers: Evidence from Public Housing” (with Russell Tsz-Nga Wong)
- (11) The Welfare Effects of Non-market Housing Allocation (with Zhongji Wei)
- (12) Managerial Scope and Span in a Relational Economy
- (13) Relational Hierarchies
- (14) Relational Investment

NON-PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES

- (15) Housing Affordability and Homeownership in Hong Kong, 1985-2023 (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, 2026-1-14, with Allen W. Huang and Alex Ngau)
- (16) Hong Kong’s Labor Force Participation Rate is Rapidly Declining Due to Population Aging (Technical note, 2025-10-29, with Yiran He)
- (17) “How Hong Kong can reimagine its greatest asset: people’s homes” (South China Morning Post, 2025-4-5, with Alex Ngau)
- (18) “Anatomy of a Housing Affordability Crisis: Hong Kong, 2001-2021” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, January 2025, joint with Jimmy Ho and Yulin Hong)
- (19) “Hong Kong’s economic recovery hinges on having enough adequate housing” (South China Morning Post, August 2024)
- (20) “Hong Kong must stop letting the well-off hog public rental housing” (South China Morning Post, May 2024)

- (21) “The Solution to Hong Kong’s Subdivided Housing Crisis” (Translated from Hong Kong Economic Journal, February 2024)
- (22) “Brain Drain, Brain Gain, and The Future of Hong Kong: Evidence from LinkedIn Profiles” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, January 2024, joint with Alan Kwan and Heiwai Tang)
- (23) “Using Data and Algorithms to Reduce Public Housing Wait Times” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, January 2024, joint with Shing-Yi Wang and Maisy Wong)
- (24) “What Caused Hong Kong’s Housing Crisis?” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, 2022)

NON-PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES (CHINESE)

- (25) 北都莫再走天水圍舊路——公營房屋必須由「租」轉「購」 (明報, 2026-5-7, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (26) 從上流階梯到階梯斷層——香港公營房屋福利的世代差距 (明報, 2026-1-29, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (27) 闡釋 1985-2023 年間香港房屋負擔能力與置業動向 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2026-1-14, 與黃唯一和牛致行)
- (28) 施政報告扶助置業方向正確 惜力度不足 (明報, 2025-10-2, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (29) 租置杳然未破局 夾心階層上流難 (信報, 2025-9-18, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (30) 房策全面改革——促進置業、重建房屋階梯、鼓勵青年上流 (明報, 2025-9-11, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (31) 公營房屋改革 會否沖跨私樓市場 (明報, 2025-8-21, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (32) 租置計劃：從失敗教訓到全民共享 (明報, 2025-7-31, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (33) 居屋二手市場流通窒息 買賣限制須大幅放寬 (明報, 2025-7-3, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (34) 居屋嚴重短缺扭曲社會發展 需大幅擴建 (明報, 2025-6-27, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (35) 現金津貼試行計劃退場 是明智決定——從經濟學理論看補貼轉型的必要性 (明報, 2025-6-5, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (36) 財赤之出路：賣公屋 救香港！ (明報, 2025-4-24, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (37) 香港經濟面臨長期衰退 房策須全面改革（下） (明報, 2025-3-21, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (38) 香港經濟面臨長期衰退 房策須全面改革（上） (明報, 2025-2-20, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (39) 剖析香港住房危機：演變與對策 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2025-1-9, 與何漢樑和洪雨林)

- (40) 要告別劏房 絕不能規管起始租金 (明報, 2024-11-7, 與宋恩榮)
- (41) 住房短缺礙引才 政府應續增建屋 (明報, 2024-8-14)
- (42) 加強富戶審查 劏房戶免受苦? (明報, 2024-5-16, 與何漢樑)
- (43) 香港劏房問題之出路 (香港信報, 2024-2-14)
- (44) 人才得失與香港前景: 領英社交資料佐證 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2024-1-10, 與關穎倫和鄧希煒)
- (45) 利用數據和算法減低公屋輪候時間 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2024-1-10, 與王欣儀和黃美施)
- (46) 香港房屋危機之謎 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2022-9-23)
- (47) 預算案 500 億推創科 怎用得其所 (香港經濟日報, 2018-3-18)
- (48) 社會面對新挑戰 須 3 方面調整 (香港經濟日報, 2017-9-13)

RESEARCH GRANTS

- 2025 HKU Jockey Club ESG Research Institute ESG Research Grant Scheme: “A New Dynamic Public Finance Approach to Housing Subsidies”
- 2023 Hong Kong RGC General Research Fund: “Price Spillovers from Large-scale Public Housing: Evidence from Hong Kong”
- 2022 Seed Fund for Basic Research, the University of Hong Kong

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Reviewer: *Quarterly Journal of Economics; American Economic Review; American Economic Review: Insights; Review of Economics and Statistics; Management Science; International Economic Review; Journal of Economic Theory; Journal of Industrial Economics; Journal of Law, Economics and Organization; Review of Industrial Organization; Labour Economics*

Invited Presentations and Discussions:

- 2026 ASSA Annual Meeting; AREUEA-ASSA Conference; HKU Stone Centre Inaugural Affiliate Workshop; HKU Stone Centre Workshop on Socio-Economic Inequality in China and the World; Seoul National University
- 2025 Kyoto University; ABFER; Society for Economic Dynamics; Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments, and Finance; Search and Matching Workshop in Asia Pacific

2024	HKU Faculty of Social Sciences; Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics; Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments, and Finance; NBER Development Economics Working Group
2023	Canadian Economics Association; GWU; Econometric Society, Beijing; Asian Real Estate Society; Econometric Society, Singapore; Workshop on Relational Contracts; Asian & Australasian Society of Labor Economics; Hong Kong Economic Association
2022	Search and Matching Workshop in Asia Pacific; Virtual East Asia Macroeconomics Seminar; Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Finance); University of Hong Kong; City University of Hong Kong
2021	Facebook (Novi); Hong Kong Baptist University

TEACHING

2026-	Senior Seminar in Economics and Finance, HKU, Instructor
2022-	Global Management from Economics Perspective, HKU, Instructor
2023-2026	Economics of Organization and Strategy, HKU, Instructor
2022	Industrial Organization II (PhD), MIT, TA
2022	Principles of Microeconomics (undergrad), MIT, TA
2018-2020	Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (undergrad), MIT, TA
2019	Applied Economics for Managers (EMBA), MIT, TA
2018	Organizational Economics (PhD), MIT, TA
2011-2012	Introduction to Computer Science II (undergrad), Harvard, TF

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2018-2022	George and Obie Shultz Fund at MIT
2017-2020	Kuok Foundation Scholarship
2015-2018	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship
2009	John Harvard Scholar
2009	Detur Book Prize

OTHER EXPERIENCES

2013-15	University of Chicago Booth School of Business, Research Professional
2012-13	Applied Predictive Technologies, Business Consultant

2011

The Greatest Good Consulting, Summer Consultant